

DISCIPLESHIP TEACHING

LEVEL 1

1ST TOPIC: ETERNAL LIFE

Text: John 3:16; John 17:3; Dan. 11:32; Mat.7:21-23; 1John 5:13;

WHAT IS ETERNAL LIFE: Knowing God and Jesus Christ. Everlasting life is also knowing God and Jesus Christ.

We know people in 4 ways: (1) **By name** (2) **By reading about them** (3) **By being told about them**, (4) By having a **RELATIONSHIP** with them.

WHY DID GOD MAKE MAN?

The goal for which God made man was for Him to have a sincere relationship with man. That is why He created man in His image (Genesis 1:26-27).

What do we benefit from being in relationship with God?

- Intimacy with God
- Deeper revelation of His word
- Provision
- Protection
- Deliverance
- Total attention of God
- The joy of His presence.

ALL THESE WERE WHAT ADAM AND EVE ENJOYED BEFORE THEIR FALL

WHY DID GOD MAKE MAN?

To have fellowship with us as He had with Adam and Eve



WHAT WENT WRONG?

Eve allowed herself to be tempted by the devil in order to disobey the one and only instruction God gave them; Adam compromised with his wife Eve and they both sinned against God and his word. (Genesis 3:1-24)

After they sinned they suffered the result of their actions as the Lord cursed them and drove them from the beautiful and perfect garden he placed them. They lost dominion to the devil and lost their relationship with God.

Note: Sin destroys your relationship with God (Is.59:2; Pro.6:16-19)

God being a merciful God sent His **WORD JESUS CHRIST** to come as a sacrifice to restore the relationship between God and Man. (John 3:16)

That is why if anyone does not believe in Jesus Christ, will perish and loose eternal life with God.

WHAT WENT WRONG?

Eve **yielded to the temptation** and **Adam compromised** with his wife to disobey the word of God



THE DANGER OF DISOBEDIENCE (Is.59:2; Pro.6:16-17)



WHAT DID GOD DO?



WHAT HAPPENS TO THOSE WHO DO NOT BELIEVE IN JESUS CHRIST?
They will perish and loose eternal life with God.

visit www.TheSecondAdam.com



HOW DO WE RECEIVE ETERNAL LIFE

- Accepting Jesus as your Lord and Savior (John 3:1-8;16)
- Genuine repentance –(2Cor. 5:17)
- Baptism – (Rom.6:1-5)
- Study the WORD of God daily (Psalm 1:1-3; 2Tim. 2:15)
- Pray without ceasing (1Thessalonians 5:17)
- Avoid all forms of worldliness (1John 2:15-17)
- Live a life of thanksgiving (1Thessalonians 5:18)

**THE CHOICE YOU MAKE DETERMINES YOUR
DESTINATION**

**THE CHOICE YOU MAKE AND THE PATH YOU TAKE,
DETERMINES YOUR ETERNAL END** [Jos.24:15; Ps.1:1-2]



**The Earth is where we make our
eternal decision**

2ND TOPIC: SALVATION BY GRACE

Text: Luke 18: 9-14

WHAT IS SALVATION: salvation is a physical demonstration of the Love of God to deliver us from sin, sickness, and all the results of sin.

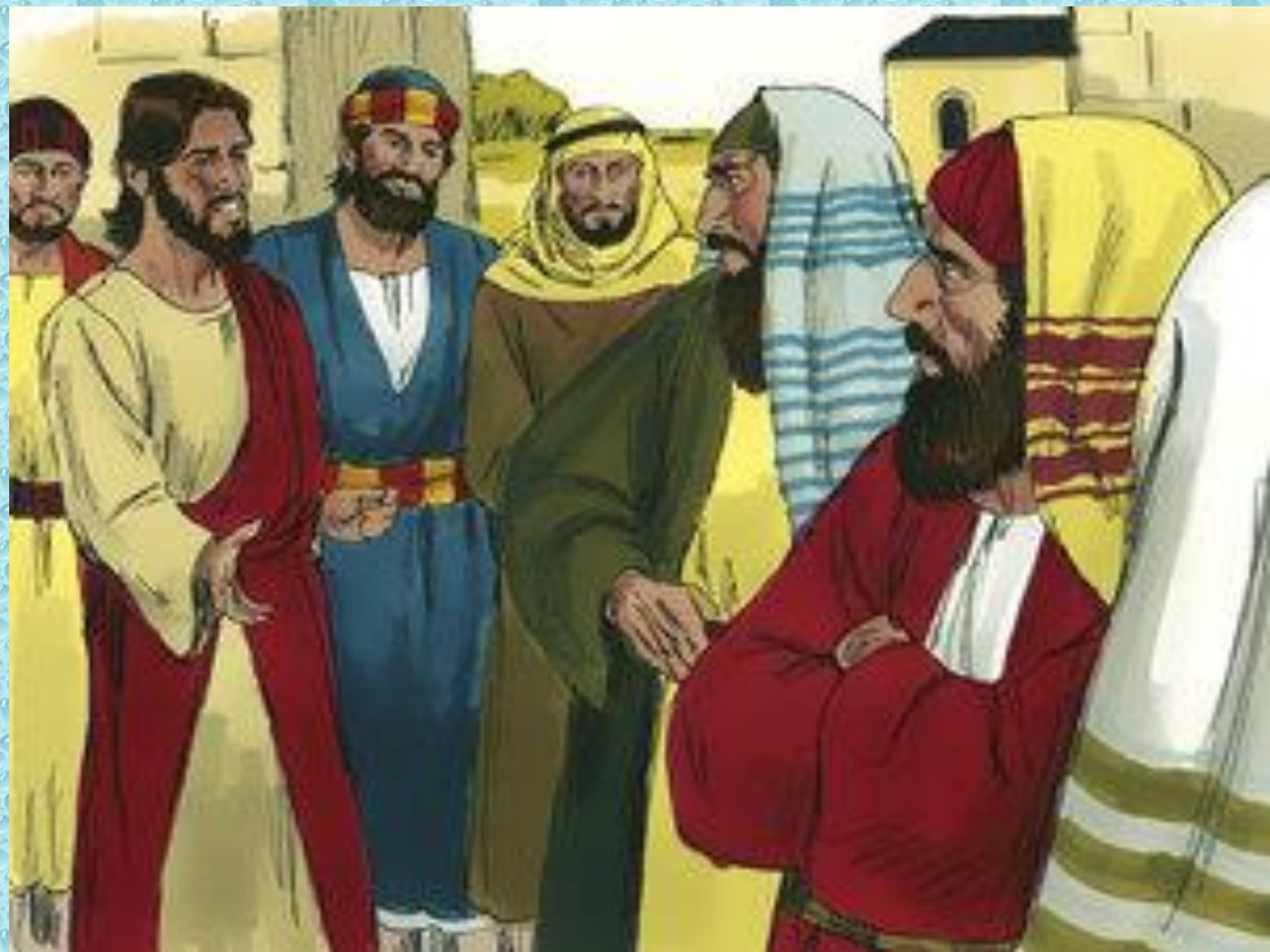
Romans 5:8 **“But God demonstrates his own love towards us in this; while we were yet sinners, Christ died for us”**

With this scripture we now know that if Christ died for us while we were yet sinners, then Salvation is actually by Grace, it does not come from any work of righteousness on our part. It is a **free gift** from God to us. (When you receive a free gift it is now up to you to maintain that gift)

WHAT IS GRACE: Grace is a free, unmerited, and an undeserved favor of God to a believer. According to definition of salvation and grace, we can now say that **salvation is a free, unmerited, and undeserved gift of God’s love that He offers anyone who truly believes in Him.**

A GOOD EXAMPLE OF HOW GOD SAVES BY GRACE

Luke 18:9-14: In this scripture we found two men in a temple praying, one of them was self righteous who felt that God will save him because he pays his tithe, and fasts twice a week etc. but the other man who humbled himself and could not even raise his hands high unto God said Lord be merciful to me a sinner. God judged their prayers and passed a verdict, granting His grace to the man who prayed in humility and believed that his works were not good enough to save him. The other man who believed in his works left the temple without the grace and answer of God because we are saved by grace and not by works.









HOW DO WE RECEIVE SALVATION?

There is only one way we receive salvation and that is through faith in Christ Jesus.

Acts 4:10-12; Rom.10:9-10

WHAT QUALIFIES YOU TO RECEIVE GRACE TO BE SAVED?

Christ in us is our qualification: Gal.1:15-16; Col.1:27

(Gifts are given for a reason)

(None of these is a WORK or what you Do but they are kingdom qualities)

- **HUMILITY**:- James 4:6; 1Peter 5:6; Proverbs 3:33-34: It takes humility for one to realize their fault and repent.

- **FAITH**: - Hebrews 11:1; **11:6**; Romans 14:23; **Mathew 9:29**: Faith gives you the courage that with God all things are possible.

- **FEAR OF GOD**: - **Proverbs 8:13**; Isaiah 33:6; **Proverbs 22:4**; The fear of the Lord in a man creates the conviction that there is a need for a savior in their lives.

When we are finally saved by grace, the next step is how to maintain our salvation, It is at this point a man says the things I used to do I do them no more, the places I used to go I go there no more etc.

3RD TOPIC: RIGHTEOUSNESS BY GRACE

Text: Romans 3:21-22; Mark 9:2-10

Note: we do not achieve or earn our salvation nor our righteousness by works for these are grace giving gifts from our God to us through Christ Jesus, but we maintain them by our works through the same grace that strengthens us (Phil.4:13)

Definition of Righteousness: It is to be in right standing or fellowship with God.

Why do we need righteousness after salvation?

After we have received salvation by grace through faith in Christ Jesus, we need to be accepted by God and to be in right standing or fellowship with Him; and this only happens if we receive righteousness by grace through faith in Christ Jesus. In other words, this is the second free gift we receive from God after our salvation.

Salvation by grace is a gift that delivers you from sin and its consequences.

Righteousness by grace is a gift that automatically brings us into acceptance and right standing with God.

This is the first gift of righteousness after our salvation it is by faith not by works, we do not earn it, we do not labor or achieve it in order to be accepted by God.

We obtain this level of righteousness the moment we accept Christ as our Lord and Savior.

TWO KINDS OF RIGHTEOUSNESS:

- **Self righteousness:** Mat. 5:20; Rom. 10:3; Is.64:6: This is the type of righteousness where one feels they earned it without the help of God by the number of their human effort.
- **God's own righteousness:** 2Cor. 5:21; Rom. 3:22: This type of righteousness is where a man feels that they can do nothing except by the grace of God. Only by the grace of God can we be made righteous through faith in Christ Jesus.

Why do we need righteousness?

Ans.: Rom. 3:10: Because no one is righteous, we are born in sin, so there is a need for one to be saved from this state of unrighteousness to a state of righteousness.

How do we receive righteousness?

Ans. Rom.3:22: By believing or accepting the Lord Jesus Christ in our heart as our Lord and personal Savior.

What kind of righteousness do we need?

Ans. 2Cor.5:21: The righteousness of God.

4TH TOPIC: RELATIONSHIP WITH GOD

Text: John 15:4-7; John 17:20-26

In our scriptural texts, we can see the love and unity between Jesus and his heavenly father.

- **Relationship has to do with deep sense of love and unity that exists between two people or group of persons. (Pro.8:17)**
- **Relationship can also be defined as friendship. (Jn.15:14)**

DOES GOD BELIEVE IN RELATIONSHIP?

The answer is YES because it was for the sake of relationship that God thought of making man in His image to rule the earth (Genesis 1:26-28) **Rev.3:20; Rom. 5:8; Jn. 3:16**

DID JESUS HAVE A RELATIONSHIP WITH HIS FATHER?

Yes: (Lk.3:21-22; Jn. 14:9-10; Jn.15:9; Jn. 10:30)

DID GOD HAVE A FRIEND IN THE BIBLE?

Yes and that friend was Abraham (James 2:23; 2Chronicles 20:7)

WHEN DID GOD ACCEPT ABRAHAM AS A FRIEND?

The day he did what God told him to do (Gen.22:1-18)

HOW THEN CAN WE BECOME A FRIEND OF GOD?

By doing the will of God the father (John 15:14-15)

WHICH PRICE DID GOD PAY IN ORDER TO RENEW HIS RELATIONSHIP WITH MANKIND?

John 3:16; God sent his only son as sacrifice

John 15:13; Christ laid down his life in order to win us back to God.

Philippians 2:8: Christ paid the price for our sins with his own life.

HOW DO WE MAINTAIN OUR RELATIONSHIP/FRIENDSHIP WITH GOD?

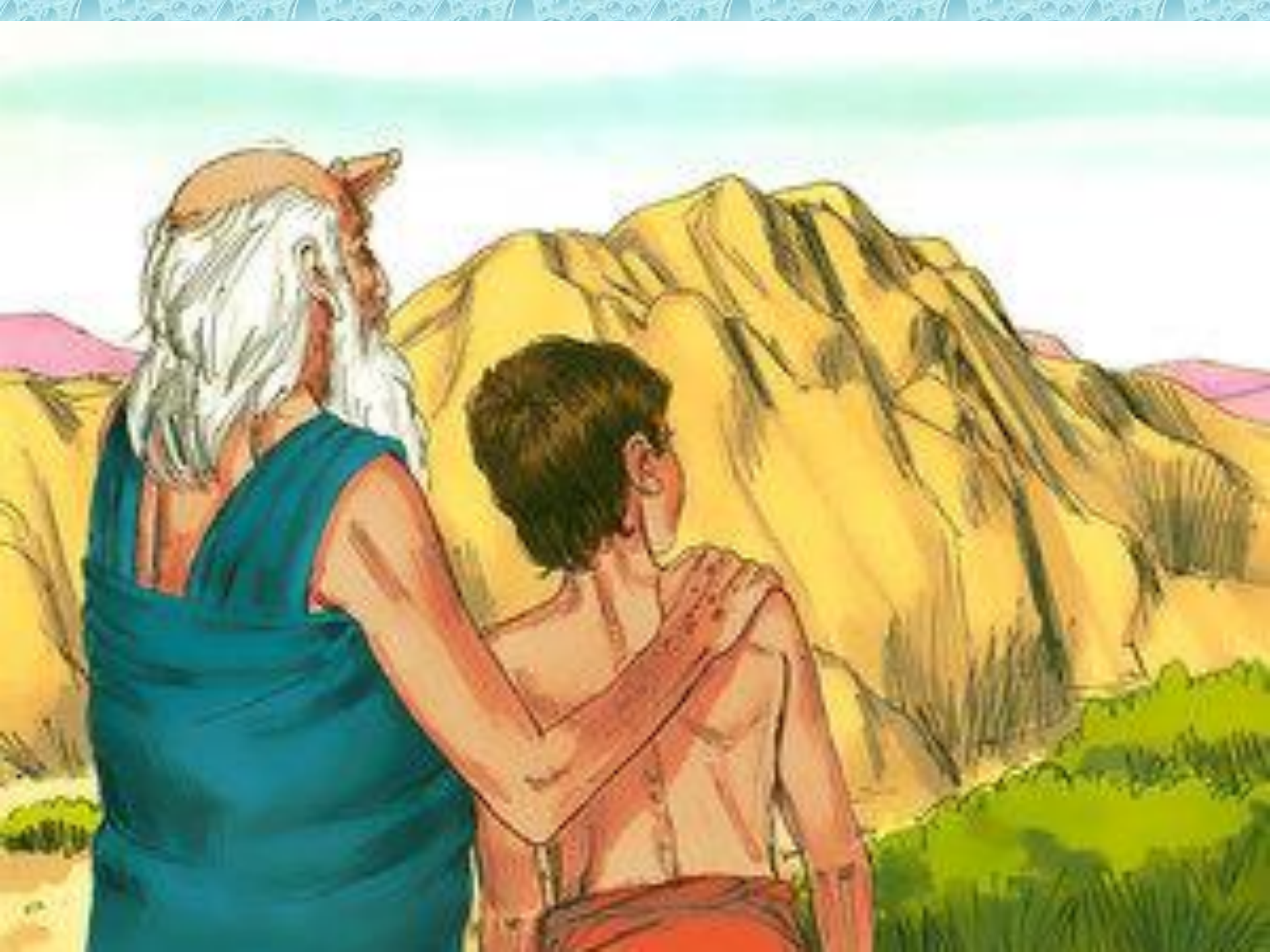
- You need to know who God really is [Daniel 11:32; John 10:14-16; Philippians 3:10; Heb. 12:14].
- Desire to do the will of God [John 15:14; James 2:23; 2Chronicles 20:7]
- Depart from sin [2Timothy 2:19; Isaiah 59:1-2]
- Be prayerful [1Thessalonians 5:17]
- Break up your relationship with the world [1John 2:15-17]
- Study the word of God [Psalm 1:1-3; 2Timothy 2:15]
- Be obedient [Isaiah 1:19; Jn.15:14-16]
- Get rid of pride and be humble [Proverbs 8:13].

WHAT IS THE PROBLEM WITH CHRISTIANS OF TODAY?

The problem is that Christians come to church services, preachers preach the bible but have no relationship with Jesus. (Mat.7:21-23; Mat.22:14; Mat.24:22)

The church that is suppose to be an ark of safety in this corrupt and sinful world, is now unreliable, unfriendly, worldly, and divisive.

(Jn.15:14)















5TH TOPIC: THE NATURE OF GOD

(Nature means, natural quality, character, or ability)

Text: **Mat. 16:13-19**; (Do not try to know people in the flesh only but also in the spirit)

Malachi 1:6; Dan.11:32; John 10:14-15; John 8:43-44

Brethren the way you know God determines the way you relate with him.

For you to have a positive relationship with God, you must know his nature.

Jesus after being with his disciples for some time he decided to find out from them that apart from they knowing his name, his earthly parental background, and the miracles he performed. He wanted to know whether they really knew who he was by nature. So he started to find out from them who others thought he was since they were closer to the people, they gave answers according to Mathew 16:13-19. After they stated the opinion of the public about who Jesus was, he now asked who they themselves think he is, only one among them got it right by saying you are the Christ, the Son of the living God. With that correct answer revealing the true nature of Jesus he blessed Peter who gave the answer.

People have different opinions about God but the three most common ones are:

- **God holds Man' sins against him [1John 1:9]**
- **God loves us just the way we are [Isaiah 1:18-19]**
- **Anything that happens to us is God. [2Pt.3:9]**

The opinion you have about God causes you to either fail or succeed in life.

330 MILLION HINDU GODs



8747 FALSE GODS





A statue of the Buddha from [Sarnath](#), 4th century CE

Born

c. 563 BCE or c. 480 BCE^{[\[1\]](#)[\[2\]](#)}

[Lumbini](#), [Shakya Republic](#) (according to Buddhist tradition)^{[\[note 1\]](#)}

Died

c. 483 BCE or c. 400 BCE (aged 80)

[Kushinagar](#), [Malla Republic](#) (according to Buddhist tradition)^{[\[note 2\]](#)}

Known for

Founder of [Buddhism](#)

Predecessor

[Kassapa Buddha](#)

Successor

[Maitreya](#)

Muslims Allah the Moon god

Is Allah the God of the Bible, or is Allah the moon god of ancient pagan Arabia? While "Allah" could refer to God literally, the Allah of Islam is the moon god of ancient pagan Arabia.

The Arabic word for "god" is "ilah", while "al" is the Arabic for "the". Therefore, "Allah" combines "al" with "ilah" and removes the "i", to literally means, "the god". But much like "YHWH/Yahweh/Jehovah" is the personal name of the God of the Bible, "Allah" was also the personal name given to the moon god, the highest of the 360 pagan idols worshipped in Mecca, Muhammad's home town.



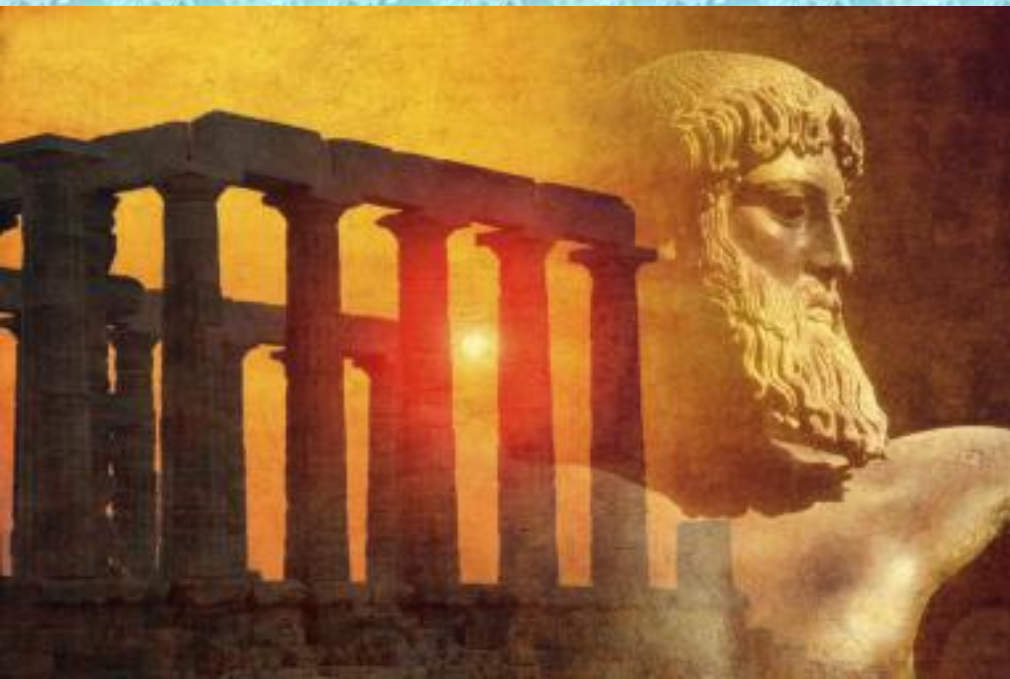
Perched atop churches is the cross, the symbol of the sacrifice made by our God. Perched atop [mosques](#) across the world is the crescent moon (above), the symbol of Allah whom [Muhammad chose](#) as the god of Islam.

Advise Muslims that if this is really the "Allah" they are worshipping, then they should stop bowing down toward a meteorite five times a day and the crescent moon should neither start their "holy" month of Ramadan nor top their mosques. If the Allah they are worshipping is the God of the Bible, then they should worship Him as the [Bible](#) instructs.

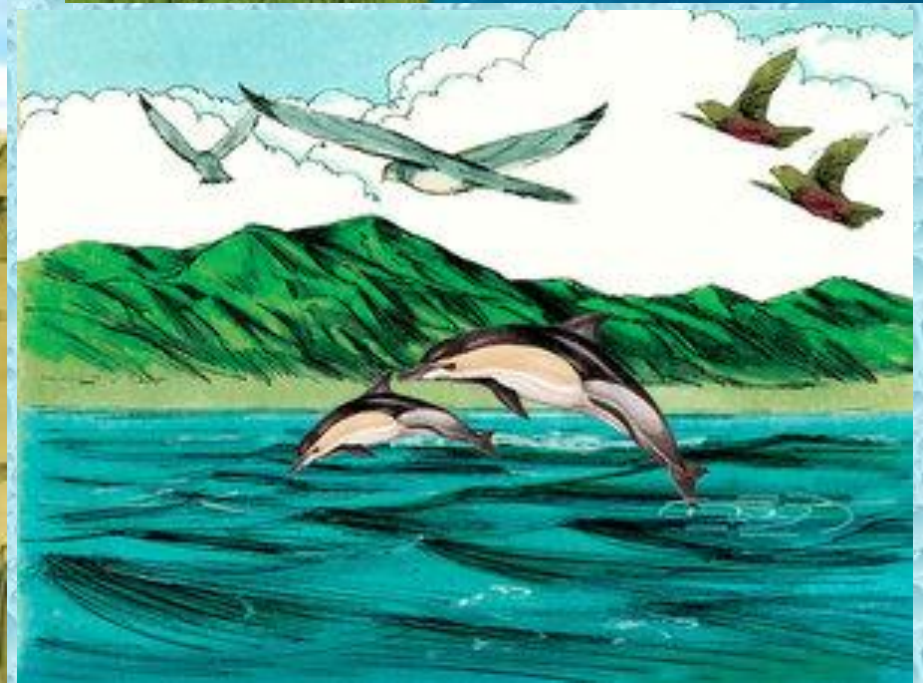
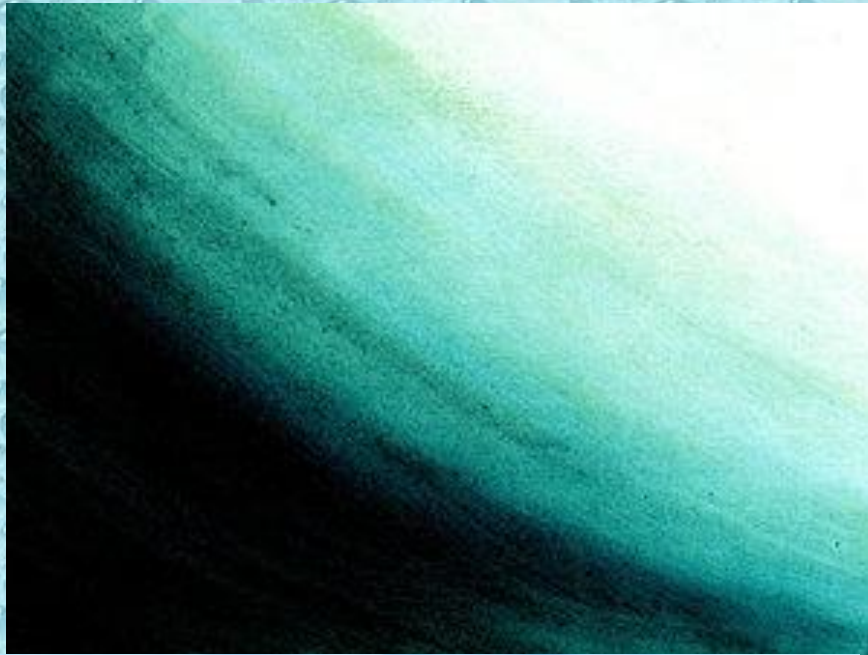
SUN GOD



The Egyptian sun god Ra was said to sail his boat across the sky by day and carry it back through the underworld by night. This depiction of Ra is from the tomb of Nefertari.



THE ALMIGHTY GOD CREATOR OF THE HEAVEN AND THE EARTH (Gen.1:1-31; 2:1-2)





WHAT IS THE NATURE OF GOD?

- God is love [1John 4:16; John 3:16]
- God is merciful [2Peter 3:9; Geneses 3:22]
- God is not partial [James 3:17; Rom. 3:29-30; 9:24-25]
- God knows all things [Heb.4:13; Psalm 139:2; Psalm 94:9]
- God blesses [Proverbs 10:22; Ecc.2:26]
- God saves [Luke 19:10]

To conclude therefore one need to know that the nature of our God is LOVE because of the following reasons:

He created the world in LOVE. [Gen.1:1]

He punished Adam and Eve in LOVE [Gen.3:21-22].

He sent Jesus down on earth because of LOVE.[Jn3:16]

He rebukes in LOVE.[Heb.12:5-6]

He denies or delays most of our prayers because of LOVE. [Mat.7:9]

He answers our prayers in LOVE.[1Jn.5:14]

Song title: The Great God.

God is greater than every other god
My God is greater,....
greater than all
He is greater than every other god
My God is greater.....
greater than all.

God is bigger than every other god
My God is bigger, bigger than all
He is bigger than every other god,
My God is bigger,.....
bigger than all

God is stronger than every other god
My God is stronger.....
Stronger than all
He is stronger than every other god
My God is stronger.....
Stronger than all.

6TH TOPIC: REPENTANCE

Text: Luke 15:11-24; 1Pt.4:8; 2Pt. 3:9 (The story of the man that stole a chicken)

DEFINITION: Repentance is a change of mind, a change of heart, and a change of direction.

Repentance is the first step towards perfection.

Repentance is turning from darkness to light, from Satan unto God. (Acts 26:18)

What is the difference between Confession and Repentance?

Confession is to expose or make known that sin before God and man; calling it what it what it is and asking the Lord for mercy.

Repentance is to make a commitment to God that you will change your way of life, your heart condition, and your direction in life unto a righteous path. Repentance is also when you declare: “The things I used to do I do them no more” (The **trap** that causes a man never to repent of their sin is **excuses**)

• Confession does not guarantee perfection, only repentance can guarantee that a person is ready to start the journey towards perfection.

• **From our scriptural text, how did we see confession at work in our story?**

Luke 15:17- The prodigal son **realized** his condition (The bible said; And when he came to himself) Luke 15:18- He decided to face his father and tell him he is a sinner (Call yourself a sinner when you sin, and do not decorate sin; call it what it is for there is only one **solution** to sin and that is Repentance)

• **How did we see repentance at work in our story?**

Luke 15:20- He took an action to step out of his first condition and go back to his father. (To repent is to step out of sin and be restored back to God)

Luke 15:21- He regretted his sinful life and could not even find himself worthy to be called a son but a servant. (It is only repentance that allows us to regret our sinful life and appreciate a decision for a new life in Christ Jesus). The energy of sin is Excuses

LESSON TO LEARN:

- When the boy was in the state of confession, his father never met him or went to look for him. You need to know that confession cannot bring you into fellowship with God. Confession is not reliable that is why you see people confessing every day without turning away from their sin.
- The bible said that the boy arose; brethren when a sinner arises to step out of their sinful life and make a strong decision never to go back to their old way of life, God comes into the life of that person immediately just the way the father in our story when he saw his son coming back home to him, he ran to his son, accepted him, changed his life, and gave him another chance to be called a son.

Brethren every day we confess our sins but how many of those sins have you decided to repent of or turn away from. Heaven is for those who confess and repent and not to those who confess only.

7TH TOPIC: COMMITMENT (The story of the Boss that tested the sincerity of his trusted workers with a seed)

Text: Luke 14:25-30; Luke 9:57-62; Luke 16:24-27; 1 Kings 8:61; 2 Chronicles 16:7-9.

Definition: Commitment means loyalty or an agreement or pledge to do something till the end.

{3 forms of commitment: 1. Circumstantial commitment, 2. Seasonal commitment, or 3. Lifetime commitment}

The word commitment is as old as creation, because it was through commitment that the entire universe was created (Genesis 1:1-31; 2:1-2). Regardless the emptiness, darkness, and deplorable state of the earth, God committed himself in making it beautiful. It was commitment that made God to work tirelessly from day 1 to day 7 at which time the bible recorded “and he rested”. It was commitment that kept God going on and on until he had created all things including man.

Note: Sincerity is the foundation of true commitment. (Always test the sincerity of people when it comes to commitment)

Commitment has to do with your “**will power**”, as the saying goes that “**where there is a will there is a way**”.

Commitment produces a special grace to hold on till the end, which means, commitment is a personal decision. Failure therefore is never a threat to a man of commitment.

Commitment is a required and effective tool used to undertake any project or duty.

Commitment is a private, personal, one-on-one pledge or oath to start and to end any venture in life.

Commitment is an effective weapon of warfare against the enemy; people who decide not to live the devil on a job in their lives and back off are **people who laugh last and laugh the best.**

It was commitment that made Jesus **to accept the sufferings, shame, and to finally go on the cross even to die just to save the world at the end.** That single committed effort of our Lord Jesus brought hope for a sinner to be saved, destroyed the power that the devil had over life and death, and elevated Jesus to the highest seat on the right hand of God the father full of power and authority, that today at the mention of His Name every kneel must bow and every tongue must confess that Jesus is Lord.

“If any man puts his hand in the plow and looks back is not fit for the kingdom of God” [Luke 9:62].

8TH TOPIC: THE PROCESS OF COMMITMENT (HOW; PART 2)

Text: Ruth 1:6-18

The story in our text, will give us a clear example on the process of commitment.

- The first process** of commitment has to do with your **personal decision**. To choose which God to serve, how to serve him, and where to serve him is a personal decision. Personal decision also means your **CHOICE**

The personal decision of Ruth ended her in the bosom of the richest man in the land as wife.

- The next process** is for you to **agree with your own decision** that it can be **possible** also known as **Determination**

This is because there are times when you decide to do a thing but then there is this confusion within you of yes or no. That is why you need to settle down with the best decision within you and move on. Ruth in our story was asked to go back by her mother in law, even her mate decided to go back especially when she heard that the mother in law had no ability to give them husbands again, but Ruth agreed with the decision within her to go with her mother in law under any circumstance.

- Another process** of commitment is for you to **make a pledge or a personal unbreakable oath** that whatever you start you will end it no matter what.

Hence you bind yourself with a pledge or an oath to do anything, your **WILL POWER** to do such thing will be activated and grace renewed to endure till the end. In our story we saw Ruth binding herself with a pledge or an oath to follow her mother in law no matter what the circumstances were. **Ruth 1:14-16 “But Ruth replied in verse 16 ; “ where you go I will go, and where you stay I will stay, your people will be my people and your God will be my God, where you die I will die and there I will be buried; May the Lord deal with me so severely if even death separates you and me”.**

Brethren this is what we call a pledge or commitment, and such commitments are only made by serious men and women who want to enter into serious business with God till they end their Christian journey at the feet of Christ in the heavenly city; {**I will serve God under any condition**} It’s a lifetime commitment.

If you make such a commitment to God as Ruth made to Naomi, even the devil will give up on you because such commitment do not leave any space for Satan to occupy; {Rom. 8:35-39}

Therefore the **way and manner or process** in which you make your commitment to God determines how far you will go with the Lord. {**circumstantial, seasonal, or lifetime**}.

If you are only committed to God for a miracle, the day you receive that miracle that will be the end of your commitment. {Many we see in the churches today are “give me Lord and go Christians”}

9TH TOPIC: NECESSITY OF COMMITMENT TO GOD AND HIS WORK (WHY; PART 3)

Text: Luke 9:62: 2Tim.2:5

There is a need to be fully committed to God and His work because we are dealing with a God whose ways are not our ways and his thoughts are not our thoughts. And God also has clear laid down principles in his word that we need to observe carefully.

Principle 1: For anyone to enter the kingdom of God, you have to be **born again** [John 3:3]. This means that if you refuse to be born again, you are saying to yourself I will never enter the kingdom of God.

Principle 2: For you to be forgiven and saved, you have to **confess and repent**. Without genuine repentance, there is no forgiveness of sin. So God works with those who have reached a point in their lives and said “the things I used to do I will do them no more”. {Luke 13:3; Acts 2:38; Acts 17:30.}

Principle 3: For you to see God at the end of your journey on earth, you must have a **pure heart** towards God and man. {Mathew 5:8}. Brethren we have Christians who are born again and are serving the Lord daily but have a very bad and evil heart towards their fellow men. Know this that Christianity without a pure heart is useless.

Principle 4: For you to be forgiven, learn to **forgive others** who ask you for forgiveness in all humility. {Mathew 5:7; Mathew 6:12} Brethren always be willing to forgive those who wrong you and come back to plead for mercy because the Lord says that we should forgive if we want him to also forgive us.

Principle 5: If you **give**, it will be given back to you with the same measure you used to give {**Luke 6:38**}This concept is very clear, that is to say, whenever you want to stop receiving just stop giving because as you stop given, the hearts of those who should give to you stops immediately.

Principle 6: Do not be ignorant of the devises, schemes or tricks of the devil {**2Corinthians 2:11**} Be sober be vigilant for your enemy the devil walks about like a roaring lion seeking someone to devour or destroy {**1Peter 5:8**}. Judas though he was a committed disciple of Jesus Christ, but when he became careless with his commitment and opened up his life, the devil entered him and made him to do what he regretted at the end and he took his own life in the process {**Luke 22:3-6**}.

Principle 7: Be ye holy for the Lord your God is holy. {**1Peter 1:16; Lev. 11:44**} when a man is running a race, their desire is to reach the end line from where you are declared a winner, so also those who come to God should desire, pray and desperately work toward being holy because holiness is a demand that God placed on anyone who decides to serve him.

Principle 8: Go ye into all the world and **preach the good news** {**Mark 16:15**} This command is not for pastors only or a special group, but it is for anyone who believes in God. If God saved you because someone talked to you, he expects you too to talk to another person to be saved also.

To conclude therefore commitment is to start, to continue no matter what and to end under any condition because grace is made available to any one who decides to be committed to the end.

10TH TOPIC: BENEFIT OF COMMITMENT (PART 4)

Text: Deuteronomy 28:1-14; Mat.4:8-11;(Lk4:5) (Luke 9:23)(Not every blessing come from God; the devil also only blesses those who are committed to him as we see it clearly in our scriptural text). The promises in Deu.28:1-14 are for those who are obedient to God.

Brethren according to our scriptural text, there is so much commitment can help you achieve in life.

Let us again examine the definition of commitment.

Commitment is an agreement, an oath, or a pledge to do something till the end.

That is to say if you agree, or decide, or pledge, or take an oath to do anything till the end, your reward is sure and certain.

For an example:

An employee is only paid at the end of the job agreement.

A laborer can only receive their wage at the end of their labor.

A student only graduates at the end of their term of studies.

A graduate can only receive a diploma or degree if only they pass in all their required courses.

With these few examples, we will see the picture of the benefit of commitment.

We will again look at few important personalities in the bible who God blessed and rewarded because of their commitment to God and His work.

Abraham: [Hebrews 6:13-15]

Jesus Christ: [Hebrews 12:2]

Paul: [2Timothy 4:7]

Commitment therefore produces grace to hold on till the end.

Genuine commitment is the easiest technique of breaking through the hearts of others; which is to say, a committed person obtains favor with God and with men.

Commitment brings out reward for any labor of yours just as we saw in the examples above.

Your relationship with God and man is guaranteed by your commitment.

God only trust men and women of commitment.

Only committed people make it to heaven.

Commitment will reactivate your joy in the Lord.

Commitment causes you to live a life of faith, hope, and thanksgiving, believing that with God all things are possible and that there is an end to everything under the sun.

These and many more are the results of true commitment, **SO DECIDE WITHIN YOURSELF TO BE A PERSON OF TRUE COMMITMENT.**

11TH TOPIC: DANGER OF UNCOMMITMENT

Text: Revelation 3:16; Luke 9:62; 1Cor.9:24-25; Ecc.9:11-12; 2Tim.4:7-8

Un-commitment denies anyone the opportunity to achieve in life. Nobody including God rewards anyone for anything done half way. Just as we said in our previous teaching on the benefits of commitment as follows:

- An employee is only paid at the end of the job agreement.
- A laborer can only receive their wage at the end of their labor.
- A student only graduates at the end of their term of studies.
- A graduate can only receive a diploma or degree if only they pass in all their required courses.

So you see, wages are gotten at the end of a job. **And another very important information I want you to take note of is: For one to finish or end a job does not altogether qualify you to earn wages, but you are only paid when you do the job well according to the expectation of the one who gave you the job.**

Commitment is a way God TEST our faithfulness and dedication to Him and His word.

Abraham's faithfulness and dedication to God was tested by God and it was after Abraham passed the test that the Lord rewarded him: (Geneses 22:1-18) let's look at Gen. 22: 12 God said, "Abraham do not lay your hand on the child; now I (God) know that you fear God, because you have not withheld your only son"

Gen. 22:16 "God said, I swear by myself that because you have done this and not withheld your only Son, I will surely bless you and make your descendants as numerous as the stars in the sky and sand on the sea shore; your descendants will take possession of the cities of their enemies, and through your offspring all nations on the earth will be blessed because you have OBEYED me GOD".

Many times we invoke the blessings of Abraham forgetting to know that Abraham received that blessing only after he had passed the TEST of commitment God gave him and obeyed the Lord God faithfully.

Even Jesus went to heaven and sat at the right hand of God Almighty after the **cross**; if he would have refused to go on the cross for our sins he would not have gone to heaven. [Hebrews12:2]

Paul won the crown after fighting the good fight of faith and finished his course and kept the faith then he was qualified to wear the CROWN of righteousness from the righteous judge God Almighty. (2Timothy 4:7-8)

Brethren, Christianity is not a bed of roses; so when you are uncommitted take note of the following:

- Uncommitment makes you neither hot nor cold and the Lord will spit you out of his presence according to our text. (Rev. 3:16)
- Uncommitment robs you of your reward with men and God.
- God condemns every act of uncommitment (Luke 9:62).
- An uncommitted person never pleases God.
- Heaven is only for those who remain faithful to God and endure till the end. (Mathew 24:13)

12TH TOPIC: INDENTITY IN CHRIST (PART 1) SPIRITUAL IDENTITY

Text: 2Corinthians 5:17-18; **2Tim.2:19**; Mat.7:15-28

Organizations and institutions issue identity cards (ID cards) to their members or students as a way of showing the world that such people or persons are registered and recognized by such organizations or institutions.

So in our scriptural text, we clearly see the proper identification of someone who is in Christ Jesus.

UNDERSTANDING THE TOPIC:

In the first place our topic today did not say **Identity OF Christ**; because the meaning of that could have been How to KNOW or Recognize Christ.

The topic rather is; **Identity IN Christ**; which if it is broken down means:

How will Christ Jesus know or recognize you as his own?

How does God the father notice that the blood of His Son Jesus did not go in vain in your life?

How will the holy Angels see you and know that you are a candidate of heaven?

How will Satan, demons, witches and wizards see you and know that you are of God and that you are not part of this world?

How do people see Christ in you?

The answer to these questions shows your **IDENTITY IN CHRIST**;

THIS IS HOW WE ARE IDENTIFIED IN CHRIST: (Eph.1:13; 4:30; Ps.51:11;Lk.3:21-22;**Jn.1:32-34;Mat.11:2-11;Act 1:4-8**)

1. You receive the **Holy Spirit of God** (Galatians 4:6) Those evil spirits that use to work in you like the ones in (**Galatians 5:19-21**) depart from your life and a holy Spirit comes in your life which causes your life to produce the following in (**Galatians 5:22-25**) (Teacher please read these scriptures)
2. You become a new creature because your old life passes away completely and gives way to your new life.
3. Everything becomes new in your life for example some friends you used to have you change them because they are not good for your new found life, you change some places you used to go, you change some cloths you used to wear, you change some things you used to eat, drink, and smoke etc.
4. The last one according to (2Cor. 5:17-18) you begin to operate in the ministry of Reconciliation.

When you experience these four Identifications, you will now be qualified to say: **I AM IN CHRIST.**

13TH TOPIC: IDENTITY IN CHRIST (PART 2) PHYSICAL IDENTITY

Text: Mathew 7:15-28

In our teaching on Identity in Christ (Part 1), we considered the following:

The importance of identification.

The true meaning of the topic Identity with Christ which includes:

The expectation of God for a born again Christian

The expectation of Christ for a born again Christian

The expectation of the Holy Angels for a born again Christian

The expectation of Satan for a born again Christian

The expectation of people or the world for a born again Christian.

Also in part 1 of our teaching we finally stated the first way of how we are identified in Christ is the presence of the HOLY SPIRIT in us.

UNDERSTANDING TODAY'S TOPIC: IDENTITY IN CHRIST PART 2

Our scripture makes it very clear that “by our **FRUITS**, they shall know us”. Brethren the fruits you bear or produce, show clearly what type of tree or person you are; because in verse 17 and 18 of our text God said that “a **good tree cannot produce bad fruits**, neither will a **bad tree produce good fruits**”. That is to say, **the life we live (our lifestyle) and the things we do, shows exactly who we really are.**

HOW MANY FRUITS DO EVERY HUMAN LIFE PRODUCE

Every human life produces two (2) fruits and they are:

THE FRUITS OR WORKS OF THE FLESH: Galatians 5:19-21 (That is before being born again) all of the works described in these verses, are things we do in the flesh when we have not accepted Jesus Christ as our Lord and Savior.

THE FRUITS OF THE SPIRIT: Galatians 5:22-25 (After being born again) all of the fruits or works described in these verses clearly reveals the character, or attitude, or the fruits of a true born again Christian.

So the condition of the human **SOUL** before and during the time of God's judgment is determined by either the **fruits or works of the flesh** or the **fruits or works of the Spirit**.

The million dollar question for each and every one of us listening to this teaching is:

WHICH FRUIT OR WORKS IS THE TREE OF YOUR LIFE PRODUCING? (Please go home pray and think about it because your answer shows your true **IDENTITY IN CHRIST**)

14TH TOPIC: THE MARKS OF A DISCIPLE OF CHRIST

Text: Galatians 5:22; 2Timothy 2:19; **Jn.13:35** {These 9 fruits of the Spirit guarantees our SALVATION which is also 9 letters)

Every institution, organization or secret cult, knows how to identify their own either by giving them identification cards or by marking some part of their body with a symbol.

The bible also states that in the last days, the devil will mark his own with the number 666 as a way of differentiating between his own souls from those who belong to Jesus Christ. **(Rev.1316-18)**

Our God also has confirmed in the scriptures that because iniquity, hypocrisy, and self righteousness has increased, He has sealed or marked his own according to 2Timothy 2:19” Nevertheless the foundation of God standeth sure, having this **SEAL or MARK**, the Lord knoweth them that are His; And let everyone that nameth the name of Christ, depart from iniquity or sin”. From this scriptural verse it is made clear that God has marked His own in these last days.

So the question now is: What are those marks of a disciple of Christ? Galatians 5:22

1. LOVE: This is the first mark of a true disciple of Christ after receiving Christ as your personal Lord and Savior, the Lord deposits His Holy Spirit in you that moment and the first fruit you produce to convince the world, the kingdom of darkness, and the kingdom of God that you are truly born again and filled with the Spirit of God is LOVE.

•The only thing we owe others according to the bible is LOVE (Rom.13:8)

What is LOVE: There are fourteen (14) definitions of LOVE in **1Corinthians 13:3-8**

- | | |
|---|--|
| 1. Love is patient | 12. Love always hopes |
| 2. Love is kind | 13. Love always perseveres |
| 3. Love does not envy | 14. Love never fails. (It did not say LOVE never ENDS but LOVE never FAILS) |
| 4. Love does not boast | |
| 5. Love is not proud | |
| 6. Love is not rude | |
| 7. Love is not self seeking (Rom.5:8; Jn 3:16) | |
| 8. Love is not easily angered | |
| 9. Love does not keep record of wrong | |
| 10. Love does not delight in evil | |
| 11. Love always protects | |

So whenever you say you LOVE God or man you are saying all 14 meaning in only 4 letter words and that is **LOVE**.

15TH TOPIC: THE MARKS OF A DISCIPLE OF CHRIST

JOY [Mat.7:18-20] Psalm 32:11 ; Nehemiah 8:10; Romans 12:12; 15:13; Mathew 25:21; Jn.15:11

Definition: The **feeling** of happiness, extreme cheerfulness. So in other words, Joy is a **feeling** and Happiness is an **experience**. This makes Joy different from happiness because a Joyful Christian walks by faith and not by sight but for happiness it is only possible when something visible happens.

In our lesson today we will learn the reason why God said in his word that one of the fruits of a Spirit filled life is Joy.

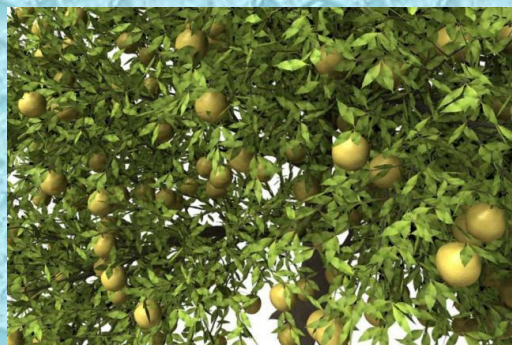
Text: Psalm 16:11; Psalm 32:11; Psalm 95:1-2; Nehemiah 8:10; Luke 1:14; Romans 12:12; Mathew 25:21.

All of these scriptural verses speak much of the importance of Joy in the life of a disciple of Jesus Christ.

WHY IS JOY THE MARK OR FRUIT OF A TRUE DISCIPLE OF CHRIST?

- Joy in the life of a believer represents your faith in God for the supernatural; as you walk joyfully in the midst of crises, you prove how solid your faith is in the God who makes impossibility possible.
- Joy is also good for your physical health; the more you stay joyful the more you get healthy because stress, discouragement, worry can result to high blood pressure or hypertension, and may also cause stroke.
- A joyful Christian confuses their enemies because they are not able to detect what is going on in their lives.
- Joy is a weapon of warfare against the devil, when he sends the arrow of disappointment, sorrow, and delay in your life, then you respond with JOY he gets confused and withdraws from you when he notices that you are not moved.
- A Joyful life keeps good friends around you.
- Joy is a coat of fire that covers your problem from the sight of your enemies and only presents them to God who sees your heart.
- A Joyful life brings long life.
- A joyful life gives grace and strength. The scripture states in Joel 3:10 "Let the weak say I am strong."
- Keeping your countenance joyful helps to keep your face youthful but frowning daily can wrinkle your face and make you older than your real age.

Unbelievers can easily accept the gospel from a Christian who is marked by a joyful life.



1st Sunday January 2nd 2022

WORSHIP SONGS

(1) YOU ARE GOD (Stanza)

You've got times and seasons in your hands
You called for light out of darkness
You don't need a man to be the God you are
You have chosen to call me your own

(Chorus)

You are God from beginning to the end
There is no place for arguments
You are God all by yourself

(2) YOU ARE BIGGER

How can I describe a mighty God like you
You are bigger than any other God
Oh what a privilege to worship at your throne
You are bigger than any other God

1st Sunday January 2nd 2022

SPECIAL SELECTION SONG

Your Grace and mercy brought me
through

I am living this moment because of
you

I want to thank you and praise you
too

Your grace and mercy brought me
through

16TH TOPIC: THE MARKS OF A DISCIPLE OF CHRIST

•PEACE

Text: Galatians 5:22, **John 14:27; 1Corinthians 14:33; Isaiah 48:22; Hebrews 12:14; Jr.29:11;Isaiah.32:17; 1Peter 3:10-11.**

Definition of Peace:

- Peace is to be free from emotional or mental disturbance
- It is a state free from oppressive and unpleasant thoughts and emotions. (That is to say, we have **EMOTIONAL PEACE & MENTAL PEACE**)
Emotion is responsible for your feeling, your mood, and your passion; and the mind of course is where all the thinking takes place, where opinions are created, and conclusions are made)
Our emotion and our mind are the battle grounds of the devil (2Cor.4:4;Mat.15:19-20;Heb.4:12; Jn10:10;Mat.9:3-4; 2Cor.10:5)

How to protect your mind: (2Cor.10:5;Ps.1:1-3)

From our scriptural text, we will know that God is the Author of peace(1Cor.14:33). Also the book of Isaiah 48:22 reveal that peace is not meant for the wicked. The devil is the author of confusion and destruction, though he cannot give peace, yet he offers **comfort** (1Pt.5:8; Jn10:10)

Peace therefore is the fruit or mark of a true disciple of Christ. Peace meant so much to our Lord Jesus Christ that the last blessing he left with his disciples was **“Peace I leave with you; my peace I give you” (John 14:27)**
Again when Christ resurrected from the grave and appeared to his disciples for the first time, the very first word that came out of his divine mouth was **“ Peace be unto you” (John 20:19)**
God in his divine wisdom as creator of the whole universe commanded us from scriptures to “seek peace and pursue it” (Psalm 34:14; 1Peter 3:11)
Peace is for true disciples of Jesus Christ because it is a state wherein a believer fix his or her eyes on Jesus and forget the storms, crises, pains, problems, and circumstances surrounding them because they serve a God who never fails, a God who neither sleeps nor slumbers, a God who is their defender and shield, a God who is their shepherd, a God who is their provider, a God who is their healer, a God who is the Alpha and Omega,a merciful God who answers all their prayers.(1Thes.5:16-18)

WRONG MENTALITY ABOUT THE SOURCE OF PEACE: (1Thes.5:1-3) (Comfort is a state of ease and freedom from pain and constraint)

- Money, wealth, or riches cannot guarantee peace if Christ is not in your life.
- No other false god or secret cult can guarantee peace if Christ is not in your life.
- The devil cannot offer peace because the bible says that he comes to steal to kill and to destroy.

So when you say that you have come out of sin, peace is what you experience and produce which makes the difference between you and the unbeliever. (**Isaiah 32:17**)
In 1 Corinthians 14:33, we are made to understand that perfect peace comes from God because he is not the author of confusion. Peace is the grace that makes us different from those of the world.
Both the devil and the false prophets will use the word of peace to lead you into confusion and destruction. (Isaiah 48:22)

17TH TOPIC: THE MARKS OF A DISCIPLE OF CHRIST

FORBEARANCE OR LONGSUFFERING (A message for achievers, goal getters, and those who want to make it big and end well in life)

Today's topic has to do with the exercise of **our WILL power** to produce patience, endurance, and a never-give up attitude till our dreams come true. **(The saying: where there is a WILL, there is a WAY)**

Text: **Ps.86:15**; Rom.2:4; Nm.14:18; **Mat.10:22**; **1Cor.9:24-25**; **Heb.6:13-15**; Jms.1:12; Galatians5:22.

Definition: Forbearance or Longsuffering means to avoid, to abstain, to refrain, to decline, or not to give heed. Also forbearance or longsuffering means to control yourself when provoked or persecuted for righteousness sake.

This virtue or mark differentiates between a true disciple of Christ and an unbeliever or unsaved person.

The strength of our WILL determines how far we can go with God or how long you can wait on God. (Is.1:19; Lk.4:5-7)

LESSON TO LEARN:

- Forbearance or longsuffering activates the grace of God in a true disciple of Jesus Christ.
- Forbearance or longsuffering is a product of Sanctification. It is the virtue or character that helps us realize that we are sanctified.
- Sanctification is the second work of grace and it deals with the inward experience of a child of God whilst salvation which is the first work of grace deals with the outward expression **(Mat.5:43-44)**
- There are inward sins such as hatred, envy, grudge, lust, malice etc. It is only when you overcome such sins that you can proudly say that you are sanctified by the grace of God. Salvation of course deals with the sins that we commit outwardly like; smoking, drinking alcohol, going to sinful places, having sinful friends, putting on sinful dresses,
- Fornication, adultery, murder, stealing etc. When a believer is saved, then they can say, **the things I used to do I do them no more.**
- Forbearance or longsuffering again is that spiritual experience that gives us the ability to avoid the path of destruction, (Psalm 1:1-3), to abstain from all appearances of evil (2Cor.6:17-18), and to control ourselves when provoked or persecuted for righteousness sake. (Mathew 5:10-12).

Brethren our spiritual strength is not in our muscle but in our **will power to say no or to avoid or to abstain from trouble, confusion, sin, or evil in any form. Therefore the strength of a true disciple of Christ is in his WILL POWER.” Not my will but your will be done oh God”.**

18TH TOPIC: THE MARKS OF A DISCIPLE OF CHRIST

[5] KINDNESS

Text: Ephesians 4:32; Colossians 3:12-14; 2Peter 1:5-8; Mathew 25:31-46; Psalm 36:7.

Definition: Affectionate, charitable giving, favorable, mild, and Forgiving.

Brethren the God we serve is a kind hearted God according to (Psalm 36:7; 63:3).

To accept Christ as your Lord and savior evidenced by speaking in tongue is not sufficient to take you to heaven. There are fruits that your life needs to produce in order for God and others to be sure that you are a candidate for heaven. One of such fruits is Kindness.

(Kindness is who you are and Goodness is what you do)

2Peter 1:5-7 “Make every effort to add to your godliness kindness”

This shows that our godliness is incomplete without Kindness. It is this virtue KINDNESS that brightens our godliness. There is a difference between Christians and other religions. That difference is only known or noticed by the fruits we produce. Today’s fruit of the Spirit which is Kindness is one of those marks which shows that we are true disciples of Christ Jesus.

QUALITIES OF KINDNESS:

A **kind** disciple of Christ Jesus easily attracts people to Christ, because people favor them and love to be around them.

A **kind** disciple of Christ Jesus loves to give people that are in need without attaching any strings.

A **Kind** disciple of Christ Jesus is mild which means they are easy to reach, they are not harsh or selfish or always walking in anger.

A **kind** disciple of Christ Jesus is considerate, tender and soft hearted, which is the definition of gentleness. They put others first, and tries to feel the way others feel

Finally, a **kind** disciple of Christ is forgiving. Even in the Lords prayer, the bible states that we should forgive others just as how Christ forgives us of our own weaknesses. So whenever you forgive those that wrong you, Christ is seen in your life at that particular moment. Therefore brethren a true disciple of Christ Jesus is not to be wild, wicked, selfish, bad, proud, heartless, mean, greedy, or evil, because these are the marks of those who belong to Satan the devil.

19TH TOPIC: THE MARKS OF A DISCIPLE OF CHRIST

[6] GOODNESS (Remember we said Kindness is what you are and Goodness is what you do)

Text: Galatians 6:9-10; James 2:15-17; Mathew 25:31-46; Proverbs 3:27; Psalm 73:1; Psalm 37:23; Psalm 34:8; Proverbs 22:1; Psalm 33:5.

DEFINITION:

- Goodness is the moral qualities which constitute Christian excellence
- An admirable quality in a person.

WHO ARE THOSE WE ARE TO BE GOOD TO:

- **YOUR SPIRITUAL LEADER OR INSTRUCTOR OF THE WORD OF GOD:** (Galatians 6:6-7; Mathew 10:41-42; 1Cor.9:11-14)

For our spiritual security and divine access to spiritual things, God has wisely set a prophet in everyone's life. The sooner you recognize that prophet and maintain them the better and safer your life becomes (Lk.16:27-31).

Brethren since we cannot see God physically, He has raised men and women to represent him on earth, so whatever we do to them, know that you are doing it to God. (Mat.25:40 “if you do it to the least of my brethren, you did to me”)

- **TO THOSE WHO BELONG TO THE HOUSEHOLD OF FAITH:** (Galatians 6:10; Mathew 25:31-46)

It is a very necessary according to the scriptures to do “good” to those who are in need in the church or the household of faith.

- **TO YOUR ENEMIES:** (Romans 12:20-21)

God being a wise God has set up a very effective method to bring your enemy down; the bible said that instead of trying to be even with your enemies or avoid them, or keep speech from them, give them anything they ask you for because your goodness to them will be used as arrow against them anytime they try to bring you down. Know this that only the method of God works well. Your own method can only satisfy your emotion and keep your enemy moving, so adopt God’s method and see fast results in Jesus name.

- **TO THE POOR:** (Proverbs 19:17)

If you want God to owe you according to the scriptures, start giving to the poor. Christians are so mean that beggars do not come to the doors of the church on Sunday but even Christian beggars are around the different mosques on Friday.

- **TO STRANGERS:** James 2:15-17; Genesis 18:1-15; 19:1-13)

Abraham from our text entertained total strangers he had never met and that one act of goodness brought about a prophesy that solved his childlessness in the space of one year. Lot also valued the life of total strangers to that of his virgin daughters, because of that God saved his family and destroyed the entire nation.

WHY DOES GOD REQUIRE GOODNESS FROM US?

- Because He God is good: (Psalm 73:1; Psalm 84:11)
- Jesus the Son of God is good: (Acts 10:38)
- The Holy Spirit is also good: (Psalm 143:10)

If we are indeed made in the image and likeness of God, then we are to be **good** Disciples of Christ Jesus because this is the mark that we need to win the world to Christ as every religion, race, or tribe is attracted to **GOODNESS**.

Brethren Jesus Christ can only be seen through the practical life we live in this evil world.

20TH TOPIC: THE MARKS OF A DISCIPLE OF CHRIST

FAITHFULNESS.

Text: Galatians 5:22; Rom.8:35-39; Proverbs 20:6; Proverbs 28:20; 2Timothy 2:2;
1Thessalonians 5:24; 1John1:9; Lamentation 3:22-23; Luke 16:10-12;
1Corinthians 4:2.

DEFINITIONS:

Faithfulness means to be loyal

Faithfulness means to have faith

Faithfulness means to be reliable, worthy of trust.

Faithfulness is not only a divine requirement but also a daily requirement from marriage couples, heads of institution, children and parents etc.

It is sad today that faithfulness is scarce in our society and time.

It is easier to get a friend but difficult to find a faithful friend.

It is easier to employ workers but it is difficult to find faithful workers.

It is easier to raise a congregation but it is difficult to find faithful members

To find someone to get married to is easy but it takes God to find a faithful partner.

Spiritual leaders are easy to find but the faithful ones are scarce.

This tells us that faithfulness is in great demand.

The next definition of Faithfulness is to have **Faith**; this is to say that you can never be faithful to God, man or to your organization if you have lost Faith or confidence in God, man, or your organization. Until you have faith or confidence in someone, or an institution, you can never be faithful to that person or that institution.

Faithfulness lies in the heart. (1Samuel 16:1-7)

THE POWER OF FAITHFULNESS

The energy of LOVE is Faithfulness

The security of Love is faithfulness

The justification of love is Faithfulness.

The mystery of love is Faithfulness

Why did God call Abraham his friend? (James 2:23; John 15:14-15)

Why did God say that David was a man of his own heart?

(Acts 13:22; 1Kings 14:8; 1 Kings 11:4)

Why did God declare Moses as the meekest man on earth?

(Numbers 12:3; Ezekiel 33:12 & 18-19)

All of these three men that are listed had their short comings or weaknesses, but the reason why God declared them faithful is because they repented of their short comings or sin and overcame their weaknesses. The mystery is, when a man sins, he is declared unfaithful; but when an unfaithful man repents of their sins, they are declared faithful by God. So it does not matter how big the sin you have committed, what matters most is your willingness to repent and walk with God in all faithfulness as these three men.

Now that you are hearing this word today harden not your heart. Stubbornness in unrighteousness attracts the wrath of God upon one's life because the bible states that stubbornness is as the sin of witchcraft.

Our God is not willing that any should perish but that all will come to repentance (2Peter 3:9).

21ST TOPIC: THE MARKS OF A DISCIPLE OF CHRIST

8. GENTLENESS OR MEEKNESS

Text: Mathew 11:29-30; Phil. 2:5-11; **Phil. 4:5**; Zeph.2:3; **Mat.5:5**; Col.3:12; Pro.16:18.
2Corinthians 10:1; 2Timothy 2:4; Titus 3:2; James 3:17

DEFINITION: > **Tender, considerate, meek, submissive, kind**

- **Soft and mild rather than hard or severe**
- **Polite and respectful rather than rude**
- **Docile which means one who yields to control, direction, or management, ready to accept instructions.**

Jesus is our perfect example because the bible states that we should look up to Jesus who is **THE AUTHOR AND FINISHER OF OUR FAITH** (Hebrews 12:2). Also Jesus is the **AUTHOR OF ETERNAL SALVATION** unto them that obey him (Hebrews 5:9).

Our scriptural text for today therefore states that Jesus is gentle and of a humble heart.

Brethren **one of the ways Christ can be seen in our life is being gentle and of a humble heart.**

HOW CAN YOUR LIFE PRODUCE THE SPIRIT OF GENTLENESS OR MEEKNESS

- Be soft, that is to be easily accessible; don't be harsh, rash or difficult to put up with.
- Be submissive and that is to be willing to **yield** to authority without resistance.
- Be mild, that means to be patient, not easily provoked, slow to get angry, calm in the midst of challenges.
- Be well mannered or civilized.
- Be respectful, regardless who the person is, because rudeness contaminates or stains our Christianity.
- The Spirit of gentleness is when you allow the right people to control you, direct you, or instruct you.
- It is also when you can manage others and be also managed.
- To be gentle is being considerate, that is, you think of others not only you. You do not forget the good that people have done to you no matter how high or great you become.

22ND TOPIC: THE MARKS OF A DISCIPLE OF CHRIST

(9)SELF CONTROL

Text: 1Corinthians 9:24-25; Mathew 16:24; 2Peter 1:5-9; 1Thess.4:3-5; Jms.4:7-8; 1Tim.4:7; [2Tim.3:16 the word of God is our training guide]

Definition: Self control is the ability to contain your emotion, that is to say, the ability to control your thoughts, feelings, and your desires. **(Putting yourself under control by yourself). Pro.23:7**

The Lord knows that there are certain situations that do not require prayer and fasting; but what we need at such times is self control which is **the self will power to resist or say yes or no or the things we can control by ourselves**.

The strength of a believer is not in his muscles but in his or her power of self control. (Mk.5:2-7)

UNDERSTANDING THE POWER OF SELF CONTROL

Self control is what we use as true Disciples of Christ Jesus to **substitute for physical strength, anointing, faith, influence, or power**. There are temptations that do not require prayer, fasting, faith or anointing; all you need to do in such situations is to resist and run like Joseph (Genesis 39:1-12).

Why sit with bad friends and allow them to draw you into sin when you have the will power to put an end to such friendship (Psalm 1:1-3).

Self control is the personal responsibility of a believer to either overcome or fail, to either win or lose.

Self control is the only effective weapon we use to overcome temptations and all the tricks of the devil.

Self control is the virtue that helps a true disciple of Jesus to determine the power of the GRACE of God in their lives (Titus 2:11-12: please read this scripture)

BIBLICAL EXAMPLES OF MEN WHO POSSESSED THE VIRTUE OF SELF CONTROL

Our Lord Jesus Christ: (Mathew 4:1-11;) Jesus resisted the temptation of the devil and overcame

Joseph: (Genesis 39:1-12) Joseph resisted the temptation of Potiphar's wife.

Elisha: (2 Kings 5:1, 14-16, 20-27) Elisha rejected the cursed offering of Naaman, but when his servant Gahazi craftily accepted that gift from Naaman, the curse of leprosy came upon him till the day of his death.

23RD TOPIC: WHAT HAPPENS WHEN A CHRISTIAN SINS?

Text: 1 John 3:1-10; Hebrews 12:1-11 (Jms.2:8-11)

There are 3 types of Christians

The **Christian that sins and gets convicted** (1John 1:8-9; Psalm 37:23-25; Romans 6:14)

The **Christian that is proud of his or her sin.** (2 Pt. 2:9- Jms 4:6; Pro. 16:18; Rom. 6:1-2; 15-16; Heb. 10:26; 3:12.)

The **Christian that cannot Sin.** (Rev. 14:1-4; Eph. 4:11-15; Heb. 6:4-6; Phil. 3:20) The third level is where every true Christian wants to reach by the grace of God.

2 WAYS TO SIN : {1} Sin of **commission** and {2} Sin of **omission**. (Mat.5:27-28) So the sin of the **heart** carries the same weight as the sin of the **act** according to Christ' teaching.

When do we become a Christian?

Not everybody that attends church service are Christians

Those who go to church with no intention to pattern their lives after Christ are known as **church goers**.

From the birth of Christ Jesus to the time he started preaching and called his twelve disciples, they were not known as Christians as of that period. But when Jesus died, the disciples who held fast to their confidence in Christ and preached Him (Christ) in words and in their deeds, People who have been watching them since the death of Christ now called them Christians first in Antioch (Acts 11:26).

So it was because of the **Christ like lifestyle** and fervent devotion to the things of God that they were labeled Christians.

What happens when a true Christian Sins?

When a true Christian sins, they regret deeply for falling into such sins
(2 Cor. 7:10-11)

A true Christian is willing to retribute after they have repented (Lk. 19:1-9)

When a Christian sins they lose joy, peace and strength (Ps. 51:12)

When a Christian sins, they do not walk in pride (Ps. 51:10-11).

When a true Christian sins, they depend on the grace of God for their restoration (Titus 2:11-14)

Two examples of men who sinned but repented and regretted such sin:

David (Psalm 51:1-19)**O/T**

Peter (Mark 14:66-72) **N/T**

24TH TOPIC: INTEGRITY OF GOD'S WORD

Text: Mark 4:10-20; 26-29; **Is.55:8-11**; Mat.25:35; **Ps.138:2**; **Jn.1:1-14**

Definition: Integrity means to steadfastly or faithfully hold unto an ethical or moral code. It is also to be complete and pure.

Integrity can again be interpreted as, **honesty, uprightness, straightforwardness, unity, wholeness, purity, goodness, godliness, sincerity, virtue, and decency.**

In other words, today we are discussing the power of God's **WORD**, or what the **WORD** of God can produce in our lives.

From our text, we know that the **WORD** of God is the **SEED**, the **SOIL** is our **NATURE**, and the **FRUIT** is the **change that our life produces**. (how long does it take for some trees to bear fruits?)

THREE (3) THINGS THE EARTH DOES TO A SEED

- **Incubation**; which means to brood, raise, or to maintain a seed.
- **Germination**: when the seed starts to grow first downwards to form the roots and upward out of the soil.
- **The release of the life of the seed**: this is when the life of the seed is seen in action as it produces fruits.

THE SPIRITUAL APPLICATION OF THESE THREE (3) PROCESSES ARE?

MEDITATION: (Incubation) It means to keep the mind fixed or focused on the word of God (Psalm 1:1-3)

HOPE: (germination) the desire of a believer that perfection is possible (1Thess. 5:8)

FAITH: (Release of the seed) This is when our life becomes a living example of Christ where people can see us and testify that indeed it is possible for flesh and blood to walk in perfection whilst on earth because the bible states that faith without works is dead. (James 2:14-18)

Difference between Faith and Hope: Faith is the Trust and Hope is the Expectation (Heb.11:1; 1Cor. 13:13)

THE POWER OR INTEGRITY OF GOD'S WORD (Ps.1:1-3; Isaiah 1:9; Hebrews 4:2)

God's word has everything we need to succeed and have victory in every area of our life.

God's word work effectively when it is being mixed with faith in your heart. What you do is to plant the word of God in your heart, mix it with faith, and expect a result.

25TH TOPIC: GOD IS NOT GUILTY

Text: James 1:13-17; John 10:10; 1Pt.5:8; Jr.29:11; Ps.136; 3Jn.2

DEFINITION: To be guilty means to be held responsible or condemnable. To commit a specified or implied offense.

The question now is, Are we right to say that God is responsible for everything that happens to us?

The answer according to our text is NO because the bible states that every good and perfect gift is from God (James 1:17)

THERE ARE 3 WAYS THAT THINGS HAPPEN TO EVERY MAN: (Hos.4:6)

• **TEMPTATION:** This is the act of influencing by exciting hope or desire. (Temptation is either to reject the truth or to ignore it)

It is Satan that causes a man to desire to do something that they know they should avoid. (Gen. 3:6) Eve from her response to the serpent in the garden means that she knew that she was not suppose to eat that fruit but the devil influenced her desire to eat what God told them not to eat. So when anyone tries to let you do what you know according to the word of God that is wrong, the person is a tempter or the devil in your life.

Satan therefore is the author of all evil (James 1:13-17; John 10:10; 8:44)

• **TRIAL:** The act of testing something; it is a preliminary competition to determine qualification; it is also a legal proceeding to determine a person's innocence or guilt by due process of the law. **It is trying to find out about something. (Some temptation is allowed to try your confession of holiness, obedience and sanctification)**

Brethren because of this wrong motive that God is responsible for all that happens to man, the devil who is the main doer of the act of bringing evil, disappointment, failure, sickness, and death upon us walks away freely in and out of our lives because **we ignorantly set him free and vindicate him from all our problems arresting our Lord God whose desire for us is of peace and not of evil to bring us to an expected end. (Job 1:6-12)**

God therefore tries us, because everything is to be tried in order to determine the best or the good one. In school the teachers do not tempt us they try or tests us to determine our level of understanding and ensure our promotion to the next level. So examination or trial for students is not a temptation but a platform for promotion and advancement.

The reason why God tries us is to truly know his own out of the many who profess to know him. God tested Abraham to determine how much love and fear of God he possessed (Gen. 22: 1-2; 10-12; 2Tim.2:19)

(3 types of students: The one that fail, the one that pass, and the one that desires a high score in exams)

• **NATURAL:** Things that you cannot change even by prayer because they are set forth by God. Example a woman's menstrual circle, no anointing can change that experience, old age, death, or day and night; whether you like it or not, night will fall and day will break etc, etc.

26TH TOPIC: THE POWER OF A SPIRIT FILLED LIFE

Text: John 14:15-17; 15:26

WHO IS THE HOLY SPIRIT?

Comforter or advocate (Jn. 14:16)

Spirit of truth (Jn.14:17)

Guide (Jn. 16:13)

Teacher (Jn. 14:26; 16:13)

WHERE DOES THE HOLY SPIRIT COME FROM?

From the Father (John 15:26)

WHEN DO WE RECEIVE THE HOLY SPIRIT?

After our salvation (Jn. 7:37-39; Acts 8:12-17; Acts 19:1-7)

HOW DO WE RECEIVE THE BAPTISM OF THE HOLY SPIRIT? (Acts 1:4-5)

By a sovereign act of God (Acts 10:44)

By the laying on of hands (Acts 19:6)

WHAT IS THE POWER OF A SPIRIT FILLED LIFE? (Gal.5:14-17)

A Spirit filled life is a yielded life to the will of God. It is at this point that a total consecrated believer can say without fear that it is no longer I that liveth but Christ that liveth in me (Rom. 8:12-14; 14:8; Acts 17:28)

Only a life filled with the Holy Spirit knows how to worship and adore God. (Jn. 4:24)

A Spirit filled person desires to study and obey the word of God and not to lose their relationship with Christ (1John 2:2-6;24)



The yield sign is a **regulatory sign**. At a yield sign, drivers must slow down and yield the right-of-way to pedestrians and vehicles that are approaching from another direction.





27TH TOPIC: THE BENEFIT OF SPEAKING IN TONGUES

Text: Acts 1:3-5; 2:1-4; 1Cor. 14:2-4.

Definition: Tongues is a physical manifestation of the infilling of the Holy Ghost.

Praying in tongues is a means to communicate with God and bypass your brain which has all the doubt and fears in it.

(1st Cor. 14:2; 1Cor.14:14)

Speaking in tongues is how we confuse our enemies.

THE POWER OF THE HOLY SPIRIT

- When the Holy Spirit comes upon us, we receive a powerful heavenly language that is beyond our imagination and that of the devil
- God never did anything in creation without the Holy Spirit; (Gen. 1:1-2)
- Jesus never did miracles until the Holy Spirit descended on him; (Mat. 3:16-17)
- The Apostles including all the believers of today can't be effective without the power of the Holy Spirit. (Acts 1:8)

WHAT HAPPENS WHEN WE PRAY IN TONGUES

- When we pray in tongues, we reactivate the power of the Holy Spirit and the part in us that has the perfect wisdom, power, and faith of God released. (1Cor.14:14)
- We speak the hidden wisdom and mysteries of God when we speak in tongues; (1Cor. 2:6-7; 14:2)
- When we speak in tongues, we build our faith in God; (Jude 20)
- The Holy Spirit helps our weakness and limitation when we pray in tongues (Rom. 8:26-27) There are times when we exhaust all the grammar in English language and go short of English words to pray with, so the Holy Spirit at this point prays for us through the tongues we speak.

EXAMPLES OF DIFFERENT MANIFESTATIONS OF THE HOLY SPIRIT.

The reason why many are confused when it comes to speaking in tongues is, they feel that the Holy Spirit has one manifestation. But the bible states that the ways of God are not our ways and his thoughts are not our thoughts. We must never limit the move of God within the scope of our human understanding or reasoning.

This brings us to three different manifestations of the same Holy Spirit.

- At Pentecost (Acts 2:1-4)
- At Cornelius house (Acts 10:1-5; 9-20; 44-48)
- At Corinth (Acts 19:1-6; 13-17)

28TH TOPIC: WATER BAPTISM

Text: Acts 8:26-38; Mat.28:19-20; Acts 2:38; Rom.6:1-4

UNDERSTANDING WHAT BAPTISM REALLY IS:

- The word baptism is not an English word but a Greek word written in English alphabet. The Greek word for baptism is “Baptidzo” which means to identify with or to be made one with.
- Water baptism is a sign and allegiance to the teachings and person of Jesus Christ (Mat. 28:19-20)
- Water baptism means identification with Christ. (Acts 26:17-18)
- Water baptism is a demonstration of our faith in Christ Jesus. (Mk.16:16; Mat.1:21)
- Water baptism is an appeal to God for clear conscience (1Peter 3:21-22)
- Water baptism is a decision to forsake ones way of life for the way of life of Jesus Christ. (Rom. 14:8; Acts 17:28)
- Water baptism is a dedication to follow the Lord Jesus Christ and become his disciple (Mat. 16:24; Lk. 9:62)

What are the requirements or obligations for baptism

There are only two (2) requirements for those desiring baptism.

- REPENTANCE:** This is a change of mind that results in an outward turning around to face and move in a completely new direction. (Acts 2:38; 20:21)
- FAITH:** Faith is a positive response to something God has done (Rom. 10:9-10; Rom.2:13; 10:17; Acts 8:37)

Because of these two reasons we can now see that it is impossible for infants to be qualified for baptism

What does God promise after baptism (Acts 2:38)

How do people see you after baptism (2Cor. 5:17)

Theme: IF NOT HEAVEN WHERE?

To make this decision as to where you will spend eternity, you need to ask yourself 3 questions:

- Where do I make this decision?
- When do I make this decision?
- How do I make this decision?

WHERE DO WE MAKE THIS DECISION?

Text: Mat.7:13; Jn.17:6-16; 2Cor.4:4; Heb.9:27; 1Pt.2:11; 1Jn.5:5

Brethren between every two way street, there is an intersection where you decide which way to take either left or right.

This world set up on the Earth is where God has placed us to make our individual decisions as to where we want to spend eternity after death.

The description given in the scriptures of how to identify our eternal pathways is that one of the ways leading to destruction has a wide gate and a broad road and the other way leading to life has a straight gate and a narrow road. So from these descriptions, we will fully understand that it is very easy for us to make a decision leading to destruction for reasons that the gate is wide enough and road so broad and very many persons are on this easy going path of life.

We also see the reality that to make a decision of spending eternity with God which the path is leading to life is a bit challenging and sometimes difficult to make and maintain.

This world is therefore the only ideal place where we make this very important and timely decision. So our Lord and Savior Jesus Christ to Him be glory and praise forever, did not leave us hopeless but prayed to God for our deliverance from the temptations and powers of this world and also gave us basic signs which will take place here on earth that we should look for to know that the time is ripe for us to make a hasty decision of where to spend our eternity. (Jn.17:6-16)

When we arrive here in this decision making world which is the intersection between our eternities, two major powers exist that influence, convince, convict and direct every man which way to take.

The lesser power is the god of this world Satan whose mission is clearly defined in scriptures: 2Cor.4:4; Jn.10:10; 1Pt.5:8 and because the devil is the god of this world, God warned us that friendship with this is enmity with God. (Jms.4:4; 1Jn.2:15-17).

The greater power is our Lord and Savior Jesus Christ to Him be glory and praise forever whose mission is not only to seek and save the lost but to give eternal life to all those who believe in him.(Lk.19:10;Jn.10:10; Jn.14:6)

Whenever you are lost or needs a direction, you need someone to show you the way. The devil satan is a deceiver he does not know the way to life because he is an enemy of life but our Lord Jesus Christ does not only know the way to life but He is the Way the Truth and the Life (Jn.14:6).

(a short clip on fulfilled prophecies of the end time)

Theme: IF NOT HEAVEN WHERE?

WHEN DO WE MAKE THIS DECISION

Text: Ecc.9:4-5; Lk.14:28-35; Mat.7:24-28; Pro.24:3-7; 2Pt.2:4-10

**Before a wise man puts his house on the ground, he first puts it on paper. In other words, he lays out design.
Every decision has consequences either good or bad.
Every traveler knows where their journey will end.**

HOW DO WE MAKE THIS DECISION?

Joel 3:14; Heb.12:1-2; 2Pt.3:14-15; 1Jn.3:1-3; Rev.1:18; 20:13-14; Rom.6:23; 1Cor.15:22-26

- **Conclude on where you want to spend eternity when you end your life' journey on earth.**
- **Accept Jesus as your absolute Lord and Savior**
- **Cut off our relationship with the world (Jms.4:4)**
- **Be ready to pay any price that will enable you to make heaven**

Which includes: been regular in all church activities, studying the word of God daily, accepting persecution as a blessing and an evidence that you are on the path of heaven, cut off your relationship with all works of evil, deny yourself, support every kingdom effort,

The face that is circled among the children in the photo is the current president of Gabon, President Ali Bongo. This boy was adopted by late Umaru Bongo from an orphan home, and was brought up as his son. Today He is the president of Gabon. No one can change what God has destined for you. So, just believe in God. He can change your situation at any time. Remember, your past does not determine your future, God does.



UNDERSTANDING THE WILL OF GOD

Text: Rom.12:2

Author: Bishop Andrew Gombay

The Good Will of God

The Pleasing Will of God

The Perfect Will of God

**"God has two dwellings; one in
heaven, and the other in a
meek and thankful heart."**

(Izaak Walton)

UNDERSTANDING THE WILL OF GOD

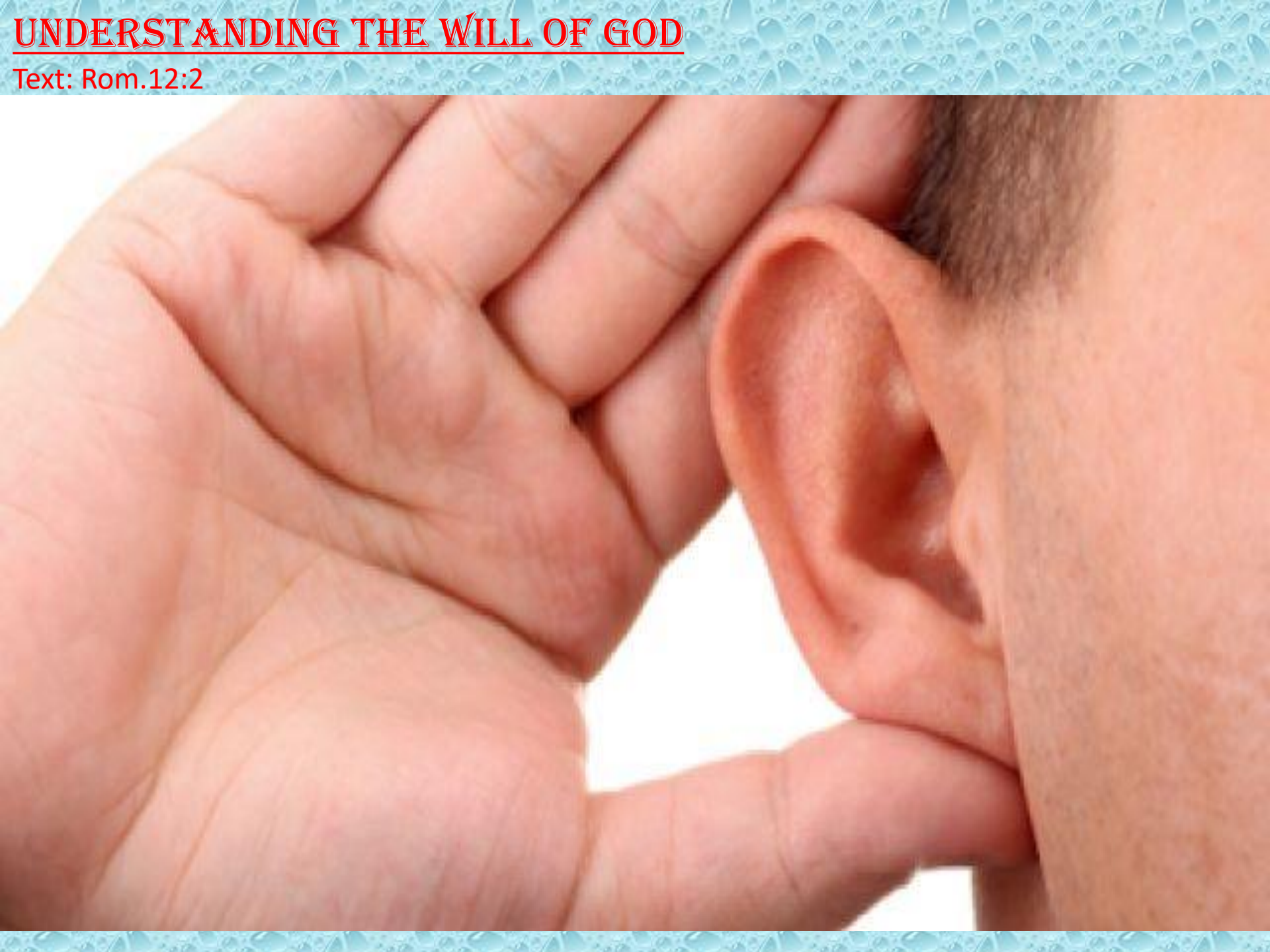
Text: Rom.12:2

*For I know the plans I have for you,
says the Lord,
plans for good and not for disaster,
to give you a future and a hope.*

Jeremiah 29:11

Author: Bishop Andrew Gombay

Faye Dykema

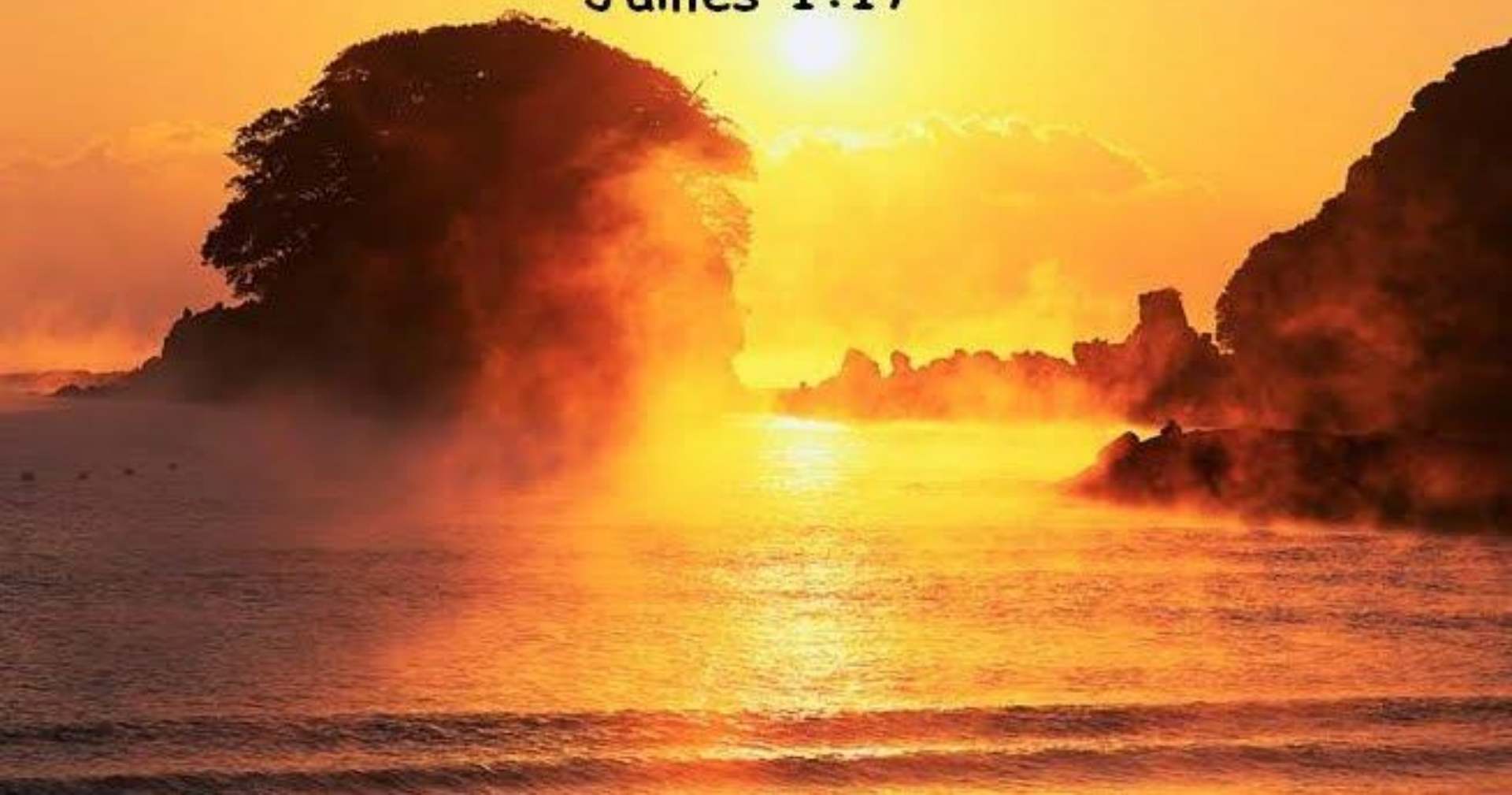


UNDERSTANDING THE WILL OF GOD

Text: Rom.12:2

Every good and perfect gift is from above,
coming down from the Father of the heavenly
lights, who does not change like shifting shadows.

James 1:17





dreamstime





CHRISTIAN PERSECUTION

ISN'T JUST SOMETHING IN THE HISTORY BOOKS INVOLVING LIONS IN THE COLISEUM. IT STILL HAPPENS EVERYDAY.



(Rev.7:12)

Amen Amen

Blessings and glory

Wisdom thanksgiving

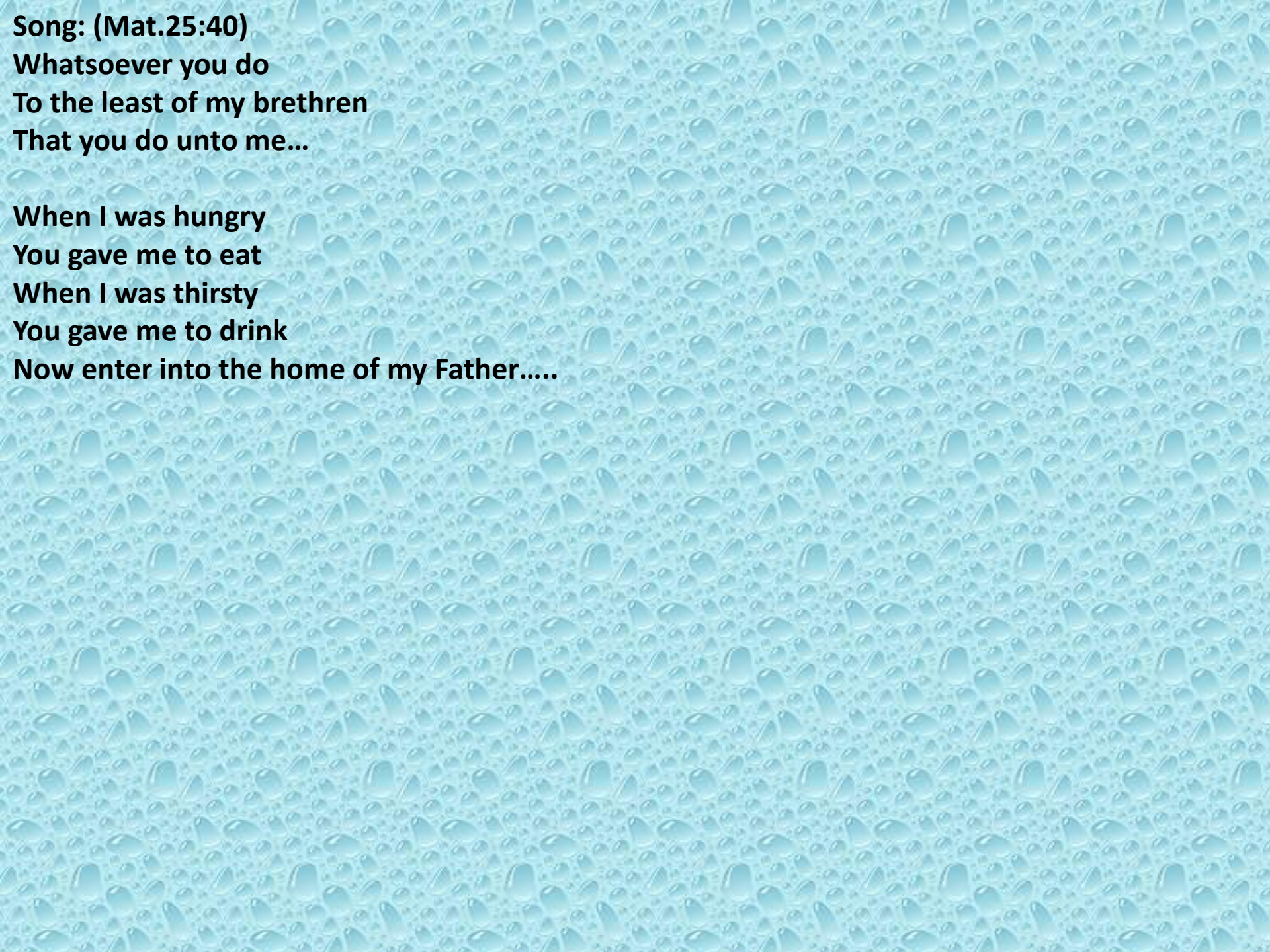
And honor

Power and might

Be unto our God

Forever and ever

A...men



Song: (Mat.25:40)
Whatsoever you do
To the least of my brethren
That you do unto me...

When I was hungry
You gave me to eat
When I was thirsty
You gave me to drink
Now enter into the home of my Father.....